



Save the Children

FLORES EARTHQUAKE RESPONSE UPDATE

15 August 2026

PROTECTING EAST NUSA TENGGARA CHILDREN'S FUTURES AMID REPEATED DISASTERS

Over 8,000 children in East Nusa Tenggara now face disrupted education and heightened protection risks—demanding urgent and sustained action.

General Overview

On 15 August 2026 at 04:58 Jakarta Time (WIB), a magnitude 7.7 tectonic earthquake struck the Flores Sea at a depth of approximately 15 km, with its epicenter located 38 km northeast of Mbay, Nagekeo District, East Nusa Tenggara (NTT) Province. The earthquake triggered a tsunami early warning from the Meteorology, Climatology and Geophysics Agency (BMKG) across several coastal regions, with minor tsunami activity subsequently recorded at 10 observation points across NTT and South Sulawesi, alongside hundreds of aftershocks.

According to official updates from the National Disaster Management Authority (BNPB) as of 17:00 WIB, the earthquake has claimed 47 lives across multiple districts—including Manggarai (24), Manggarai Timur (17), Sikka (3), Ngada (1), and Ende (1)—with dozens more suffering injuries requiring emergency medical treatment.

Public infrastructure essential for children's well-being has been heavily impacted, damaging 87 educational facilities and 18 healthcare facilities—directly impacting more than 8,000 children across affected communities. Ground reports also confirm extensive residential destruction, leaving 157 houses severely damaged, 41 moderately damaged, and 148 lightly damaged, alongside damage to 5 places of worship and 6 government offices.

The earthquake hits against a backdrop of existing, compounding vulnerabilities—specifically the ongoing El-Niño-influenced drought and the recurring eruption hazards of Mount Lewotobi. For affected children, the cumulative impact of these successive disasters extends far beyond immediate survival, severely threatening their health, protection, education, psychosocial well-being, and long-term development.

Standing with Children: What They Need Most Now

The earthquake has compounded existing vulnerabilities caused by recurrent disasters in Flores, placing children at heightened risk. Protecting children's well-being and future requires more than

addressing their immediate humanitarian needs; it demands sustained investment in their recovery and resilience.

Alongside life-saving support, equal priority must be given to restoring essential services, strengthening family and community resilience, and creating opportunities for children to recover, learn, and thrive. Only a balanced approach that pairs immediate relief with long-term recovery can safeguard children's development, dreams, and futures.

- **Short-Term Priorities:**
Restoring access to education, strengthening health and nutrition services, and supporting families' livelihoods are essential to prevent learning loss, malnutrition, child labor, early marriage, and other protection risks. Child-Friendly Spaces and psychosocial support must be integrated into recovery efforts to help children cope with distress and uncertainty.
- **Long-Term Priorities:**
Investments are urgently needed in disaster-resilient schools, climate-adaptive WASH systems, resilient community infrastructure, and child-centered disaster risk reduction. Strengthening children's resilience today will safeguard their health, education, development, and opportunities tomorrow.

Our Response So Far

Save the Children Indonesia (SCIDN) has established immediate contact with local implementing partner, CIS Timor, in East Nusa Tenggara (NTT). Preliminary discussions highlight the urgent need for further assessment of the earthquake's impact on children and their families, particularly regarding immediate access to safe shelter, basic necessities, and protection. As a critical next step, a joint assessment has been agreed upon to gather detailed data on children's specific needs and vulnerabilities to guide priority response actions.

Going forward, if drought conditions persist and recovery efforts are prolonged, children will face increasingly complex humanitarian challenges, especially across Child Protection, WASH, Health and Nutrition, and Education in Emergencies Situation. Without timely and sustained support, the combined toll of the earthquake and drought could jeopardize not only children's immediate safety and well-being, but also their long-term development, learning, and future opportunities.

Save the Children Indonesia's Priority Response Sectors

1. **Child Protection:** Preventing violence, exploitation, and family separation. SCIDN is actively monitoring unaccompanied children, family tracing and reunification, potential institutionalization/orphanage risks, and heightened child trafficking risks during disaster situations.
2. **Education in Emergencies (EiE):** Ensuring continuous and safe learning for every child, addressing the severe disruption in damaged educational facilities.
3. **Health and Nutrition:** Delivering critical care, focusing on children aged 0–23 months (U-2 children), as well as pregnant and lactating mothers.
4. **Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS):** Helping children process trauma, build resilience, and cope with distress.
5. **WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene):** Preventing disease outbreaks in evacuation sites and temporary shelters.

Monitoring of the needs of affected children and families is ongoing, aligned with evolving conditions on the ground and official updates from government and disaster management authorities.

Social Media Updates

Instagram: Save the Children Indonesia | August 15